

India vs UK Tech Market

A comparison of skills, tools, pay and experience

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Executive Summary

- Compared 2,182 Indian and 1,907 UK respondents across skills, tools, pay and experience
- The most-used languages are near-identical in both markets — the core stack transfers
- Divergence in tools: the UK leans Microsoft, India leans MongoDB, MySQL and Google Cloud
- The raw 5x salary gap narrows to 2.3x once experience is held constant
- AI tool use differs sharply and significantly — 61% daily use in India against 38% in the UK
- Recommendation: for someone moving markets, the proportional gain is largest early in their career

Introduction

The problem

The survey covers 177 countries but reports mostly global figures. Averages flatten the differences between markets, so a developer in one country cannot tell how their skills, tools or pay compare with another.

India and the UK are both well represented in the data, so the two can be compared directly.

Questions investigated

- Which languages, databases and platforms dominate in each market?
- How does pay compare, and does the comparison survive controlling for experience?
- How much experience does each market's workforce hold?
- Does AI tool adoption differ between the two?

Audience: anyone planning a move between these markets, and hiring teams comparing talent pools across them.

Methodology

1

Data collection

Stack Overflow Developer Survey 2025, downloaded directly from the published release. 49,191 respondents, 172 columns.

2

Data exploration

Checked sample sizes before committing. Ruled out a data-roles-only comparison — only ~112 UK respondents held data jobs.

3

Data cleaning

Excluded students and retired respondents. Removed 62 impossible salaries. Left missing values out rather than imputing them.

4

Analysis

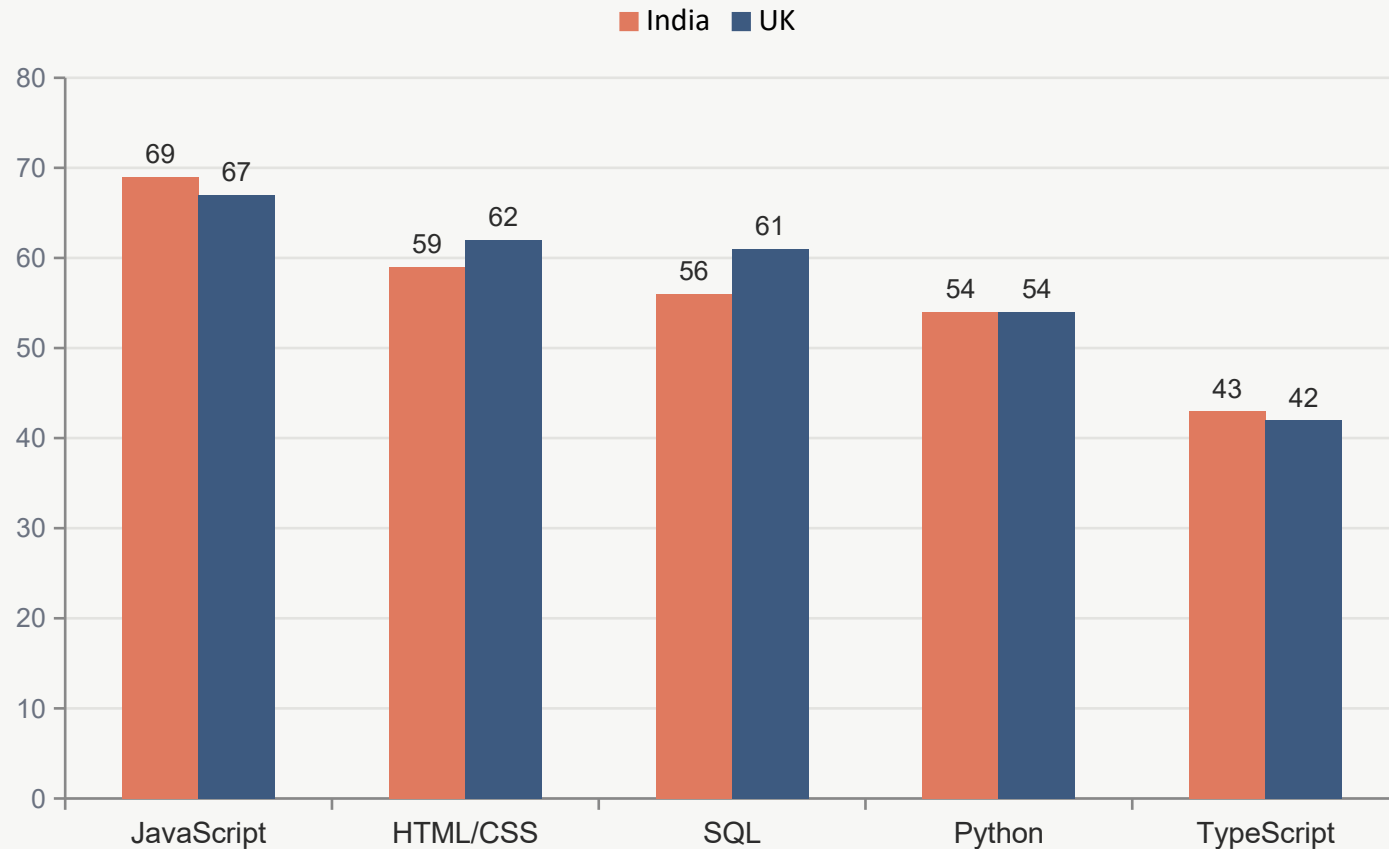
Percentage comparisons across four skill categories, salary banded by experience, and a chi-square test on AI adoption.

5

Visualization

Charts in Python (matplotlib) and a formula-driven dashboard in LibreOffice Calc.

Results — the core stack is the same



Percentages of each country's respondents, not counts.

Within a few points

The most-used languages are almost identical in both countries. The baseline skills transfer between markets, so someone moving would not need to relearn the fundamentals.

Results — but the tooling diverges

UK leans Microsoft

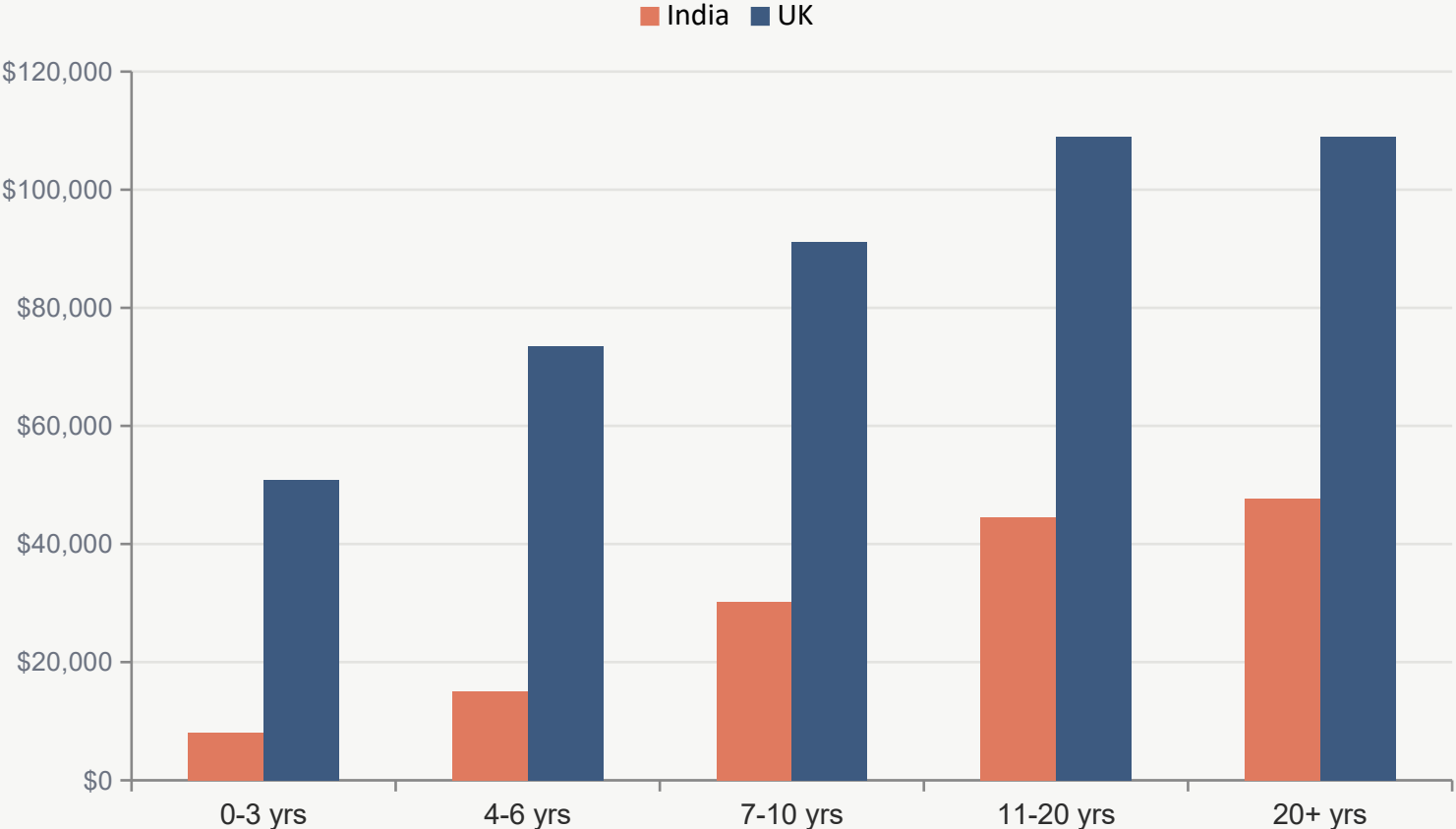
- C# 34% vs 17%
- PowerShell 26% vs 15%
- SQL Server 36% vs 26%
- Azure 34% vs 25%
- NuGet 24% vs 11%

India leans elsewhere

- MongoDB 45% vs 17%
- MySQL 58% vs 36%
- Google Cloud 33% vs 24%
- Firebase and Cloud Firestore
- Java 37% vs 22%

MongoDB is the largest single gap in the skills data — 28 points. AWS, PostgreSQL, Docker and Kubernetes are near-identical in both.

Results — the salary gap is not what it looks like



6.3x

gap at entry level

2.3x

gap at 20+ years

Raw medians differ by about 5x, but UK respondents hold twice the experience. Comparing like with like, the gap narrows steadily.

Results — AI use differs significantly

Use AI tools daily

61% **38%**

India

UK

Won't use AI at all

5% **26%**

India

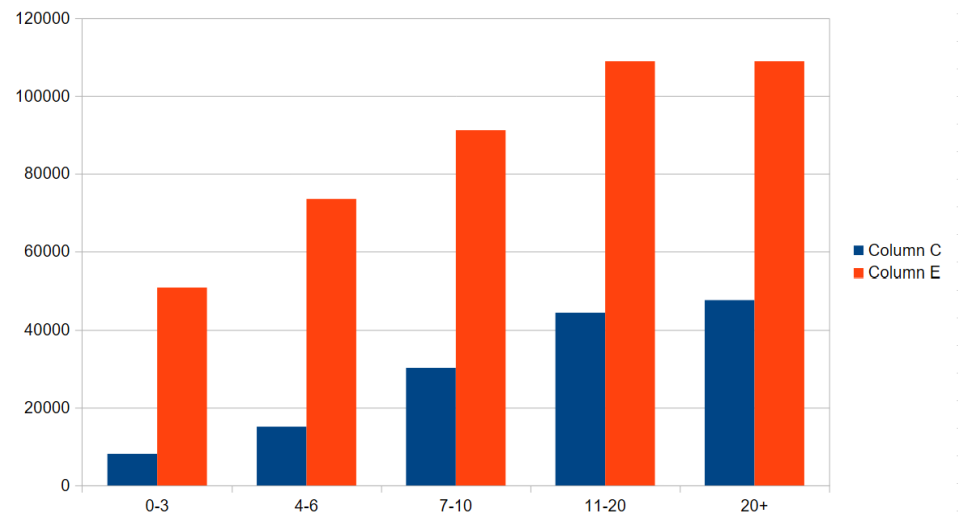
UK

Chi-square test: $p < 0.000001$. The difference is not chance. Weekly and occasional use are almost identical in both countries, the entire difference sits at the two extremes.

Dashboard

Built in LibreOffice Calc, saved as .xlsx

- Five source sheets: salary by experience, languages, databases, platforms, AI adoption
- A summary view built on live SUMIFS, COUNTIFS and VLOOKUP formulas, not pasted values
- A gap column comparing the two markets on every measure
- Figures recalculate automatically if the underlying data changes

[illegible]

Full workbook: india-uk-dashboard.xlsx in the project repository

Findings & Implications

1

Shared core stack

Baseline skills transfer between markets. No need to relearn fundamentals when moving.

2

Divergent tooling

Someone moving from India to the UK should expect Microsoft tooling like C#, Azure, SQL Server, to be more commonly required than their experience suggests.

3

Pay gap narrows with seniority

The value of changing markets depends heavily on career stage, not just on geography.

4

Indian pay plateaus early

\$44k at 11-20 years rises to only \$47k at 20+, while the UK plateaus at a far higher level.

Conclusion

Move earlier rather than later

The relative gap is widest at entry level — 6.3x against 2.3x for senior people — so the gain from changing markets is largest at the start of a career.

The counter-argument

These are raw dollars. Adjusted for cost of living the difference would narrow considerably, and I have not made that adjustment. So this is a conclusion the data points toward rather than one it proves.

Skills transfer. Tooling doesn't. Timing matters most.

Appendix — limitations

- 1 Self-selected sample**

Respondents chose to take part and mostly already use Stack Overflow. Not representative of either country's workforce.
- 2 Half skipped salary**

51% of respondents gave no salary and 28% no country. Every figure comes from those who answered.
- 3 Raw dollars only**

No cost-of-living adjustment. What people can actually afford is closer than the figures suggest.
- 4 Why remains unknown**

The AI difference is real and tested, but the survey never asks why it exists.
- 5 Experience is a proxy**

Years worked does not capture seniority directly. Two people with ten years may be at different levels.